



MISSOURI HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
WITNESS APPEARANCE FORM

BILL NUMBER: HB 2123		DATE: 3/10/2026	
COMMITTEE: Higher Education and Workforce Development			
TESTIFYING: ☒ IN SUPPORT OF ☐ IN OPPOSITION TO ☐ FOR INFORMATIONAL PURPOSES			
WITNESS NAME			
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION:			
WITNESS NAME: BRIAN MILLNER		PHONE NUMBER: 573-634-8787	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME: MISSOURI COMMUNITY COLLEGE ASSOCIATION		TITLE: PRESIDENT	
ADDRESS: 2420 HYDE PARK RD.			
CITY: JEFFERSON CITY		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65109
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE:	SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 12:00 AM	

THE INFORMATION ON THIS FORM IS PUBLIC RECORD UNDER CHAPTER 610, RSMo.



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WITNESS NAME			
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION:			
WITNESS NAME: LEAH STRID		PHONE NUMBER: 573-751-6561	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME:		TITLE:	
ADDRESS: 301 WEST HIGH ST.			
CITY: JEFFERSON CITY		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65201
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE:	SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 12:00 AM	
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WITNESS NAME			
REGISTERED LOBBYIST:			
WITNESS NAME: PAUL WAGNER		PHONE NUMBER: 529-7195	
REPRESENTING: COUNCIL ON PUBLIC HIGHER EDUCATION		TITLE:	
ADDRESS: 717 WESTPORT DRIVE			
CITY: COLUMBIA		STATE: MO	ZIP: 65203
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE:	SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 12:00 AM	
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WITNESS NAME			
INDIVIDUAL:			
WITNESS NAME: ARNIE C. "HONEST-ABE" DIENOFF-STATE PUBLIC ADVOCAT		PHONE NUMBER:	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME:		TITLE:	
ADDRESS:			
CITY:		STATE:	ZIP:
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE: In-Person		SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 11:57 PM

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I am Opposed to this Bill. I Fiscal Note is \$39-Million, when we NEED to Cut \$2-Billion from the State's Annual Budget.



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WITNESS NAME			
INDIVIDUAL:			
WITNESS NAME: SARAH BERRY		PHONE NUMBER:	
BUSINESS/ORGANIZATION NAME:		TITLE:	
ADDRESS:			
CITY:		STATE:	ZIP:
EMAIL:	ATTENDANCE: Written		SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 7:52 AM
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HB 2123 represents a significant shift in Missouri’s higher education policy by tying both scholarship eligibility and institutional funding models more closely to workforce priorities.

While workforce development is an important objective, public institutions of higher education serve a broader mission that includes intellectual development, civic education, research, and the advancement of knowledge across a wide range of disciplines. A funding model that prioritizes workforce outcomes risks narrowing the scope of higher education and placing disproportionate emphasis on short-term labor market demands.

The bill also introduces a performance-based funding structure that may incentivize institutions to adjust academic offerings primarily based on workforce metrics. Such an approach could unintentionally disadvantage programs that provide long-term societal value but do not produce immediately measurable workforce outcomes.

Additionally, the scholarship modifications tied to “eligible programs of study” may create financial incentives that steer students toward certain fields while discouraging others. Students should retain meaningful freedom to pursue academic paths that align with their abilities, interests, and long-term aspirations.

Missouri’s higher education system benefits from institutional diversity and academic independence. Funding models should strengthen that system without unduly narrowing its focus to workforce outcomes alone.

For these reasons, careful reconsideration of HB 2123 is warranted.



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WITNESS NAME			
REGISTERED LOBBYIST:			
WITNESS NAME: MAVIS DEY		PHONE NUMBER: 573-239-3785	
REPRESENTING: MISSOURI FAMILIES FOR HOME EDUCATION		TITLE: LOBBYIST	
ADDRESS: P.O. BOX 261			
CITY: MARYVILLE		STATE: MO	ZIP: 64468
EMAIL: staff2@fhe-mo.org	ATTENDANCE: Written		SUBMIT DATE: 3/10/2026 12:07 PM
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Homeschool graduates occasionally deal with unreasonable attitudes towards their parent issued diploma. Yet, homeschooling has a track record of graduates who do very well academically, as is well documented by research and test scores. Missouri Families for Home Education is offering a simple fix to the language in HB 2123 that deals with Bright Flight scholarship eligibility.

Current language: page 2, line 18

... completion of a program of study through homeschooling or any other program of academic instruction that satisfies the compulsory attendance requirement under section 167.031; “

FHE would like to suggest that the wording on line 18 be changed to clarify that a homeschooled student is a graduate from a high school, as opposed to one who has merely completed a program of study. This was suggested by an attorney with much experience defending homeschool families.

Suggested change: page 2, line 18

“...graduation from a program of study through homeschooling or any other program of academic instruction that satisfies the compulsory attendance requirement under section 167.031;”

(On a personal note: two of my graduates did qualify for Bright Flight scholarships to attend in-state university. I appreciate the intent of HB 2123).

Thank you for considering this minor change to language.